

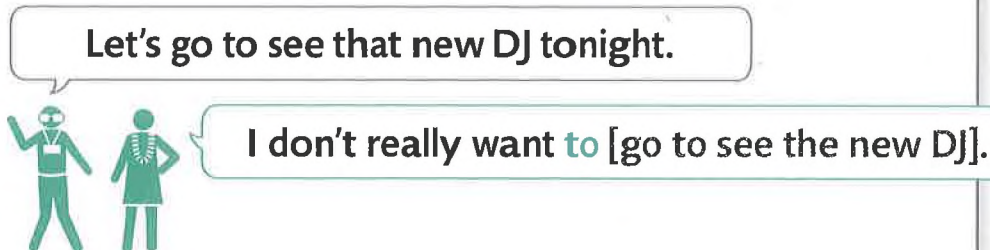
64 Shortening infinitives

As well as ellipsis and substitution, you can also shorten (or “reduce”) infinitives to prevent repetition. This will help you to sound more natural when speaking.

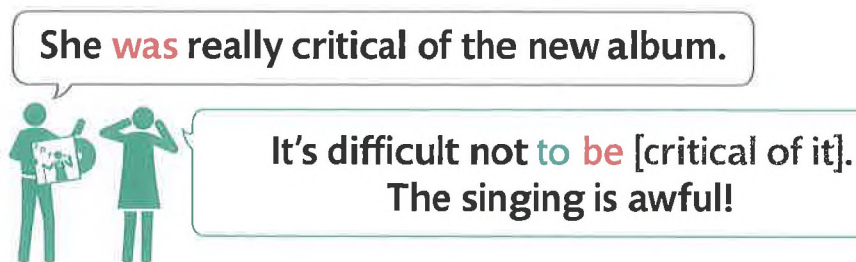
 **New language** Reduced infinitives
Aa Vocabulary Music and performance
 **New skill** Avoiding repetition

64.1 KEY LANGUAGE REDUCED INFINITIVES

You can use “to” on its own rather than repeat the entire infinitive verb. You can only do this if the meaning remains clear.



If the previous sentence or clause contains the verb “be,” then you must use to “be” in the next clause or sentence.



64.2 CROSS OUT ALL OF THE WORDS THAT YOU CAN LEAVE OUT

I want to get the best tickets for the show, but can't afford to ~~get them~~.

- ❶ I tried to contact Max about the concert tickets, but wasn't able to contact him.
- ❷ My brother often forgets our dad's birthday, but this year he's promised not to forget.
- ❸ Georgia was enjoying the performance. At least, she seemed to be enjoying it.
- ❹ Ian is going to the new nightclub, but I don't really want to go to there.
- ❺ The festival tickets cost a lot more than they used to cost.
- ❻ I want to come with you, but I won't be able to come with you.

